

occasionally do things 'wrong' deliberately. The work that goes into those results that appear interesting can be applied in other situations. Eventually you'll find your distinctive, personal style that allows you to convey the world to others from your own, unique viewpoint.

Look In Your Backyard

One mistake many photographers make is to think they have to go to unique places to get unique photographs. This leads you to ignore the possibilities nearby and at-hand.

Because we admire the work that great photographers did in scenic locations - like Ansel Adams at Yosemite - we often think we have to go there too! What's often forgotten is that these people were shooting in their own backyards. They knew the area and its lighting intimately. They took photographs of the same places over and over again from different vantage points and under different lighting to build their skills.

To build your skills, photograph the same things over and over again as the light changes. Try different points of view, and different angles and compositions. You have no excuse not to do this because unlike these earlier photographers, you're not spending money on film when you try new things.

Play With The Horizon Line

When photographing outdoors, one of the key elements in many images is the horizon line and where you place it in the image. Some photographers like to follow the rules, and place the horizon line so it's one-third up from the bottom of the image. This rule may give interesting images, but you'll do better trying different things. Despite what some people believe, there are no rules in photography. If there were, photography would be a lot easier than it really is.

Look For Unusual Atmospherics

In the rising or fading light at dawn and dusk, you can often see unusual lighting in the sky. One approach to photographing these scenes is to place something interesting